



Market study: who we serve, who we fight, and what one user costs.

Segmentation · TAM / SAM / SOM · competitors and prices · unit economics · why the category has no leader yet.

WHY A MARKET EXISTS

Most new members quit before month three. A coach fixes that. Almost nobody can afford one.

63%

of new gym members quit before month 3

Fewer than 4% are still going after a year.
One in three members leaves every year.

54%

of beginners do not know where to start

Half say the weights area intimidates them.

€35-40 /h

for a personal trainer in Barcelona

Two sessions a week is €280+ a month.
The gym itself averages €38.

The apps people already own log what happened. Nobody tells a beginner what to do next.

WHO WE SERVE FIRST

We segment by the **problem**, not by age.

● PRIMARY

Beginners who need direction

"I joined a gym, but I do not know what to do."

Program builder • goal setup • coach questions

● PRIMARY

People who start and stop

"I get motivated, then I lose the routine."

Streaks • daily goals • friends • rankings

● SECONDARY

Casual users juggling apps

"My workouts and my food are in different apps."

Training + fuel + coach in one

● SECONDARY

Motivated by competition

"I train more when friends join."

League • crews • step goals

● SECONDARY

Nutrition-first users

"I need an easier way to track food."

Meal photo • macros • hydration

● LATER

Experienced lifters

"I need precise programming and analysis."

Volume analytics • plan import

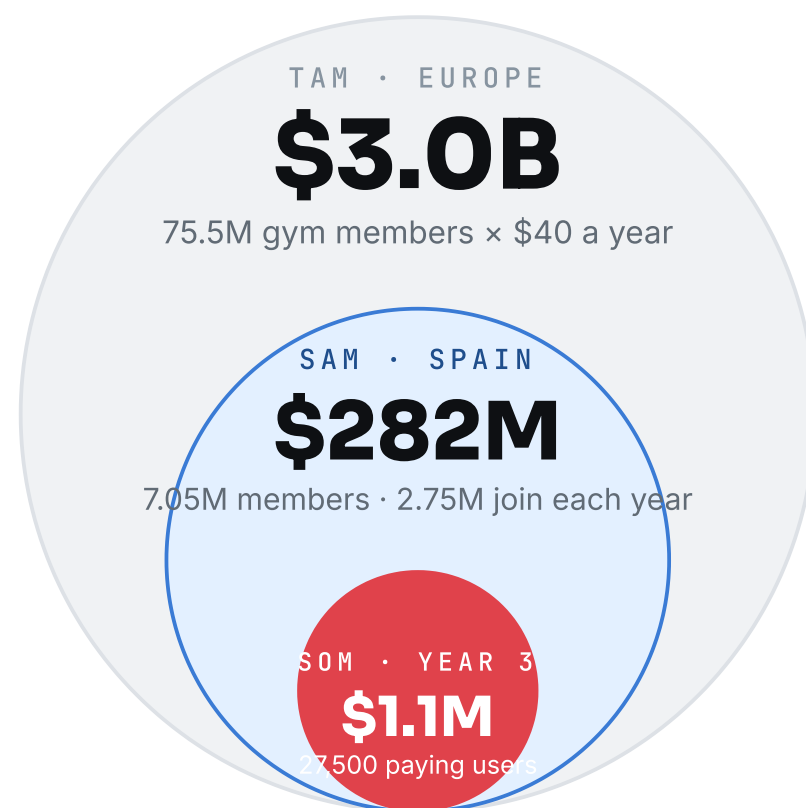


Alex, 23 • student in Barcelona • new gym member

"Give me a clear plan and help me keep following it." Illustrative persona, not an interviewed customer. First test: 15 interviews in Barcelona.

TAM • SAM • SOM • BUILT FROM GYM MEMBERS, NOT FROM ANALYST HYPE

Europe is a **\$3 billion** market. Spain is our first **\$280 million**.



TAM • EVERY GYM MEMBER IN EUROPE

\$3.0B / year

75.5M members × \$39.94, the median annual fitness-app price.
Top-down check: Europe is 26% of the \$12.3B global market = \$3.2B.

SAM • SPAIN, WHERE WE CAN REACH AND OBSERVE USERS

\$282M

7.05M members, 16.5% of adults. 39% are new each year: 2.75M beginners. Barcelona alone has 733k members.

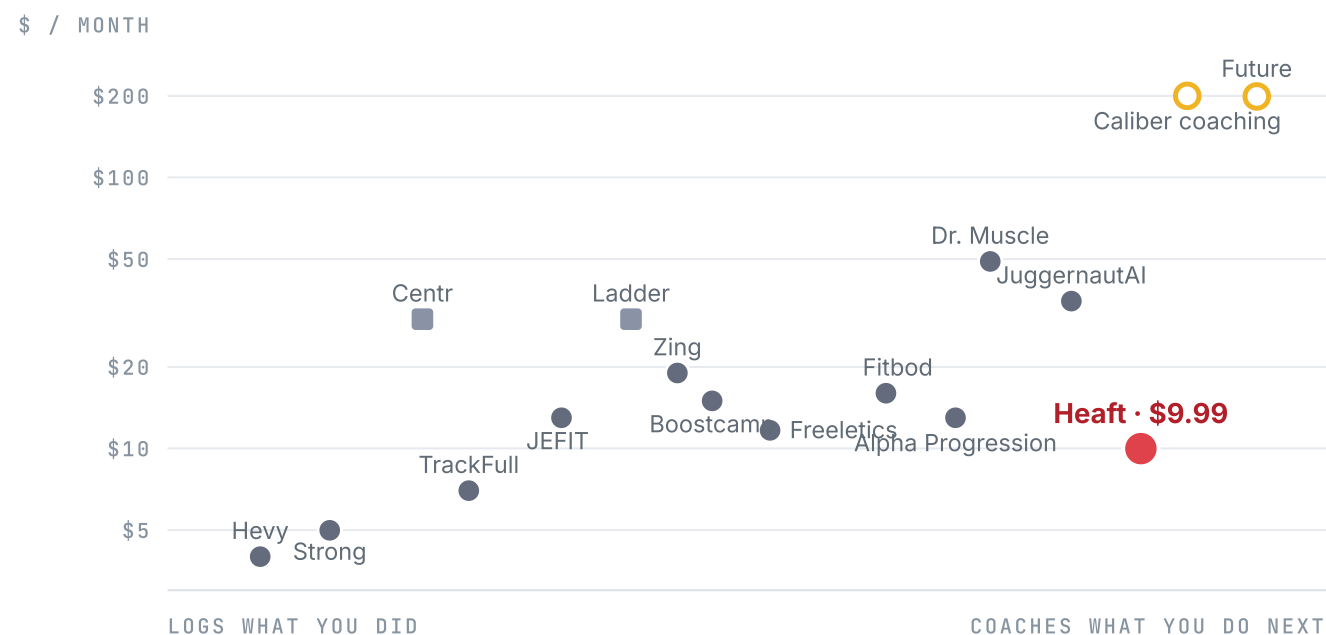
SOM • WHAT WE CAN WIN BY YEAR 3

\$1.1M

1% of Spain's yearly new joiners paying = 27,500 subscribers. At the 2.9% download-to-paid median that needs ~950k installs.

THE LANDSCAPE • PRICE VS HOW MUCH THE APP COACHES YOU

Cheap apps **log**. Apps that **coach** cost \$13 to \$200. The middle is empty.



● SOFTWARE • LOGGERS & GENERATORS

Hevy and Strong record sets for \$4. Fitbod, Alpha Progression and JuggernautAI generate workouts for \$13 to \$35, but none talks back or feeds you.

■ CONTENT • VIDEO LIBRARIES

Centr and Ladder sell the same weekly programme to everyone. Not adapted to your lifts.

○ HUMANS • REAL TRAINERS IN AN APP

Future and Caliber coaching at \$199 to \$200 a month. A real coach, at a real coach's price. Future tried AI and shut it down in June 2026.

● HEAFT

Writes the week, runs the session, adapts next week, moves your food targets, answers questions. At the category's median price.

Prices US App Store listings read 15 Sep 2026; Freeletics shown as its 3-month Coach block ÷ 3. Position on the x-axis is our reading of each product's own marketing. Vertical axis is logarithmic.

WHAT THEY CHARGE • US APP STORE, 15 SEP 2026

We price at the category median, **\$9.99**, and give more for it.

APP	FREE TRIER	PER MONTH	PER YEAR	WHAT THE "AI" REALLY IS	RATING
Hevy Barcelona · 16M users	Yes	\$3.99	\$23.99	NO AI logger + social feed	4.9
Strong	Yes	\$4.99	\$29.99	NO AI logger	4.9
TrackFull closest to our shape	Yes	\$6.99	\$69.99	FEEDBACK comments on what you logged	—
Freeletics 54M registered	Limited	\$11.66	\$79.99	GENERATOR weekly re-plan, bodyweight roots	4.6
Fitbod 15M downloads · raised prices Aug 2026	Trial only	\$15.99	\$95.99	GENERATOR recovery model, no chat, no food	4.8
Zing Coach	Trial only	\$18.99	\$59.99	QUIZ → TEMPLATE plus check-ins	4.8
JuggernautAI	Trial only	\$34.99	\$349.99	RULES ENGINE powerlifting only	4.8
Future	No	\$199	—	HUMAN real trainer by message	4.9

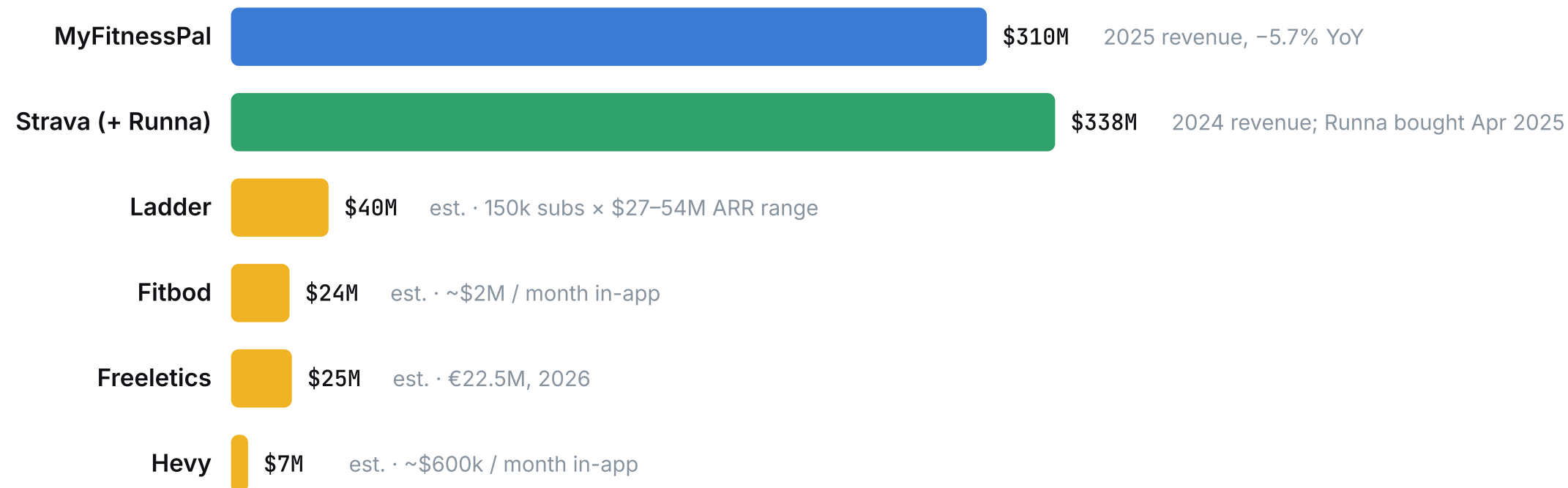
Category benchmark (RevenueCat 2026, health & fitness): **\$9.99 / month** • **\$39.94 / year** • trial → paid **37.7%** • download → paid **2.9%**

Sources Apple App Store US listings (15 Sep 2026) • Freeletics 3-month Coach \$34.99 ÷ 3 • Hevy, Freeletics, Fitbod user counts from their own sites • RevenueCat State of Subscription Apps 2026. Ratings are US App Store; TrackFull has too few ratings to show one.

WHO ACTUALLY MAKES MONEY • ANNUAL REVENUE, USD

The money is in **food** and **running**. No gym coach app has passed \$50M.

■ Nutrition ■ Running ■ Gym / strength



Health & fitness apps took **\$4.5B** of in-app revenue in 2025 (+13%) while downloads grew only **0.8%**

. The market pays more, not more people. Whoever owns the gym behaviour, the way Runna owned running, takes the open seat.

Sources Business of Apps (MyFitnessPal 2025) · Sacra (Strava 2024) · Yahoo Finance / BusinessWire (Ladder subs, Nov-Dec 2024) · Sensor Tower public teasers (Fitbod, Hevy monthly IAP, early 2026) · Die Deutsche Wirtschaft (Freeletics est.) · Sensor Tower, State of Mobile H&F 2025. "est." = analyst estimate, not company disclosure. Peloton (\$2.4B) omitted: hardware and classes.

WHY NOBODY LEADS THE AI-COACH CATEGORY YET

Four reasons the seat is still **empty**.

1 • "AI" IS A LABEL

Most "AI coaches" are a quiz and a template

Real adaptive engines exist, but they are niche and silent: no dialogue, no nutrition.

28% of health & fitness apps now bid on "AI" keywords, up from 19% a year earlier. Sensor Tower, Feb 2026.

2 • SPLIT IN THREE

Loggers, generators, humans. Nobody does all three

\$4 apps record. \$13–35 apps generate. \$199 apps put a person on the phone.

Reviewers frame the market as "algorithmic vs human-first, no dominant leader". Big brands (Centr, Ladder, Nike) ship content, not coaching.

3 • TRUST NOT YET EARNED

People do not believe an AI coach yet

So the coach must prove itself in week one, with a real plan, not a chat box.

Only 10% prefer AI guidance to a human coach; 37% undecided. Les Mills 2026 (10,000+ people). Future killed its AI beta in June 2026.

4 • RETENTION KILLS EVERYONE

Whoever survives the first six weeks wins

The category loses almost everyone; the winner is the one that keeps beginners.

Day-30 retention 3–4%. First renewal: monthly 57%, annual 25%. RevenueCat H&F, Apr 2026; Business of Apps.



The proof it can be done: Runna

One behaviour (running), plans that genuinely re-adjust from last week, \$19.99 a month. Acquired by Strava in April 2025. The gym version of Runna does not exist yet.

FEATURE BY FEATURE

Others **log or generate.**
Heaft runs the whole loop.

Capability	Hevy / Strong	Fitbod	Freeletics	TrackFull	Future	Heaft
Writes your program for you	—	✓	✓	—	✓ human	✓
Next week changes from your logs	—	✓	~ weekly feedback	—	✓ human	✓
Runs the session live (sets, rest timer, cues)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Two-way coach chat that knows your data	—	—	~	~ feedback cards	✓ human	✓
Nutrition target follows today's training	—	—	~ paid add-on	~ diary only	—	✓
Swap an exercise, reason remembered	—	~	~	—	✓ human	✓
Scan a coach's written plan (PDF / photo)	—	—	—	—	—	✓
Cycle-aware training and hydration	—	—	—	—	~ human	✓
Friends, crews, leaderboards	✓	—	✓	✓	—	✓
Price per month	free · \$4	\$13	\$13	\$7	\$199	\$9.99

✓ yes ~ partly — not offered "human" = a person does it, not software

Basis competitor rows from each company's own store listing and website, read Sep 2026 ("not offered" = not claimed in their marketing). Heaft rows are shipped code in the repository. Prices rounded; see the pricing slide for exact figures.

WHAT ONE USER COSTS US • PER MONTH

A free user costs 13 cents.
A Pro user costs 43 cents.

FREE USER • TYPICAL MONTH

\$0.13 / month

12 workouts • 20 coach messages • 1 generated program • 10 meal photos

Coach chat • 20 msgs × \$0.0018	\$0.035
Program + 4 weekly updates	\$0.023
Session analysis • 12 × \$0.0025	\$0.030
Meal photos • 10 × \$0.0002	\$0.002
Server share (at 1,000 users)	\$0.039
Total	\$0.13

PRO USER • TYPICAL MONTH

\$0.43 / month

16 workouts • 150 coach messages • 2 programs • 2 plan scans • 60 meal photos

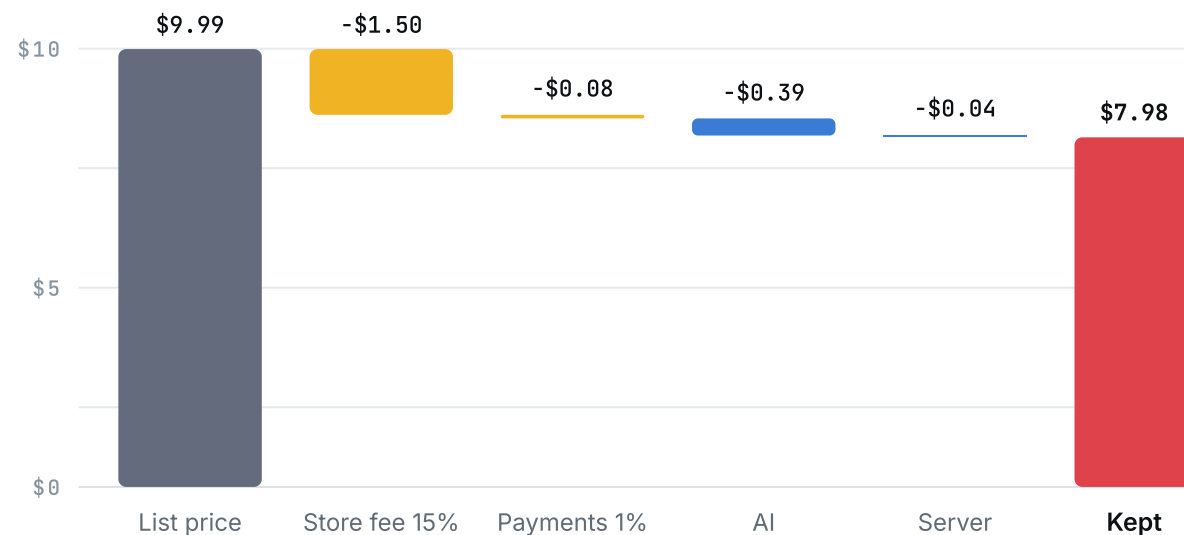
Coach chat • 150 msgs × \$0.0018	\$0.263
Programs, updates, weight tips	\$0.044
Session analysis • 16 × \$0.0025	\$0.040
Plan scans 2 × \$0.014 • photos 60 × \$0.0002	\$0.043
Server share (at 1,000 users)	\$0.039
Total	\$0.43

Worst case: a Pro who hits every daily quota (1,500 messages, 4 scans, 300 photos) costs **\$2.89** a month. Still below the price.

Rates Cerebras gpt-oss-120b \$0.35 / \$0.75 per 1M tokens • Together Llama 3.3 70B \$1.04 • Gemini 2.5 Flash-Lite \$0.10 / \$0.40 • Gemini 2.5 Flash \$0.30 / \$2.50 (list prices, 15 Sep 2026). Token counts per call estimated from Heaft's prompt code. Server = DigitalOcean 4 GB droplet \$24 + backups + domain + store fees = \$39 / month fixed.

DOES ONE PRO SUBSCRIPTION PAY?

One monthly Pro keeps **\$7.98** and pays for **62 free users.**



MONTHLY PLAN • \$9.99

80%

of the list price stays with us. One Pro pays for 62 free users. Break-even conversion: **1.6%** of users.

ANNUAL PLAN • \$59.99 = \$5.00 / MO

76%

stays with us (\$3.78). One annual Pro pays for 29 free users. Break-even conversion: **3.3%**.

FIXED COSTS • \$39 / MONTH

5 Pros

on the monthly plan (or 11 annual) cover the whole server, backups, domain and store fees.

Assumptions Apple Small Business Program and Google Play subscription fee 15% • RevenueCat 1% above \$2.5k monthly revenue • typical Pro AI use \$0.39 • server share at 1,000 users. A Pro who maxes every quota (\$2.89 AI) still leaves \$5.51 on the monthly plan.

WHAT THE BUSINESS LOOKS LIKE AT SCALE • PER MONTH

At the category's median conversion, Heaft is profitable from **1,000 users**.

USERS	PAYING (2.9%)	REVENUE KEPT	AI COST, FREE USERS	AI COST, PRO USERS	SERVERS	PROFIT	MARGIN
1,000 Barcelona pilot	29	\$205	\$87	\$11	\$39	\$67	33%
10,000 Spain, year 1-2	290	\$2,048	\$874	\$113	\$63	\$999	49%
100,000 Spain + first EU markets	2,900	\$20,482	\$8,739	\$1,125	\$400	\$10,217	50%
100,000 at top-quartile conversion, 6.2%	6,200	\$43,788	\$8,442	\$2,406	\$400	\$32,541	74%

The biggest cost line is the AI we give away to free users, not the Pros. Blended break-even conversion is 1.3% . The lever is the freemium boundary: which coach features stay free.

Assumptions revenue kept = list price minus 15% store fee and 1% payments; 68% of subscribers monthly, 32% annual (RevenueCat H&F mix) → \$7.06 kept per Pro • free user AI \$0.09, Pro AI \$0.39 • servers: 4 GB droplet \$39 → 8 GB \$63 → larger box + managed Postgres ≈ \$400. No marketing or salaries included. Team costs are the real next question.

HOW WE BECOME THE FIRST FULL COACH

Nobody owns "the coach" yet. The seat is **open**, and the maths says we can afford to sit in it.

BET 1 • PRODUCT

**Lead with the programme,
not the log**

A new user sees a generated week before logging anything. Nutrition follows the day. Next week gets harder on its own.

BET 2 • PRICE

Coach depth at logger prices

\$9.99 a month sits between the loggers (\$4) and the AI generators (\$13), and 20× under a human coach app (\$199). Each Pro still keeps 80%.

BET 3 • SEGMENT

Win beginners in their first 6 months

The half who quit by month six are the people no logger serves. Barcelona students first, 15 interviews, then the numbers decide.

Built, not finished. The study says the market is real and the margin is real. The next three weeks test whether beginners agree.

WHERE EVERY NUMBER COMES FROM

Sources

Market & members

- EuropeActive & Deloitte, European Health & Fitness Market Report 2026 (2025 data): 75.5M members, €39.1B, Spain 7.1M. europeactive.eu
- Deloitte, Fundación España Activa, FNEID, Informe anual del sector del fitness en España, 1st ed. 2025: 7.053M members, 16.5%, €3.235B, €38.2/month.
- 2Playbook / Adecaff, Estudi del sector del fitness a Barcelona 2025: 733,061 members, €476M, 42% penetration.
- Health & Fitness Association, 2025 Fitness Industry Benchmarking Report: 66.4% retention. healthandfitness.org
- Fortune Business Insights, Fitness App Market 2026: \$12.27B (2025), Europe 26%, 13.6% CAGR. Grand View Research and Precedence give \$12.1B.
- Research and Markets, AI Personal Trainer Market: \$16.9B (2025) → \$35.3B (2030).
- Sensor Tower, State of Mobile Health & Fitness 2025 and Health & Fitness Apps & AI (Feb 2026): \$4.5B IAP, +0.8% downloads, 28% AI keywords.

Behaviour, competitors, costs

- Sperandei S., Vieira M.C., Reis A.C. (2016), J Sci Med Sport 19(11): 63% quit before month 3, <4% at 12 months. PubMed 26874647
- Les Mills 2026 Global Fitness Report: 54% don't know where to begin; 10% prefer an AI coach.
- RevenueCat, State of Subscription Apps 2026 and renewal rates by category (Apr 2026): \$9.99 / \$39.94 medians, 2.9%, 37.7%, 57% / 25% renewals.
- Apple App Store US listings, 15 Sep 2026; company sites (Fitbod, Freeletics, Hevy, Future, Zing, JuggernautAI); Athletech News (Future, Jun 2026); Strava press (Runna, Apr 2025); Business of Apps (MyFitnessPal); Sacra (Strava).
- Trainer prices: roeis.es (Barcelona), coachway.io (DE), Bark (UK), GoodRx (US), all 2026.
- Costs: Cerebras, Together AI, Google Gemini pricing pages; DigitalOcean droplets; Apple Small Business Program; Google Play fees; RevenueCat pricing. All read 15 Sep 2026.
- Heaft cost model: token counts per call estimated from Heaft's own prompt code; usage personas are assumptions, not measured traffic.